Shared Drives: Map a Network Drive (Windows)

A **mapped network drive** lets you access a shared folder on another computer or file server as if it were a local drive (such as Z: or X:).

Method 1: Using File Explorer

1. Open **File Explorer**.
2. Select **This PC**.
3. Click **Map network drive**.
4. Choose an available **Drive** letter (for example, Z:).
5. In the **Folder** field, enter the shared folder path (UNC path), for example:

\\ServerName\SharedFolder

6. Select **Reconnect at sign-in** if you want Windows to reconnect the drive automatically after you log in.
7. If the shared folder requires different credentials, select **Connect using different credentials**.
8. Click **Finish**.
9. Enter your username and password if prompted.

The shared folder will now appear under **This PC** as a mapped drive.

Method 2: Using Command Prompt

Map a network drive

net use Z: \\ServerName\SharedFolder

Map a drive using different credentials

net use Z: \\ServerName\SharedFolder /user:DOMAIN\username *

You will be prompted to enter the password.

Disconnect a mapped drive

net use Z: /delete

View all mapped network drives

net use

Tips

- Ensure your computer is connected to the same network or VPN as the file server.
- Verify that you have permission to access the shared folder.
- If the drive doesn't reconnect after a restart, enable **Reconnect at sign-in** when mapping the drive.

Using the